

privacy- centric vertical that dash and monero occupied, both of which were in the top 10 of cryptocurrencies in terms of network value when zcash was released. The excitement was palpable.

Integral to the ensuing price bubble was how the Zcash team structured the issuance of zcash, which they did with good intention. As we discussed in [Chapter 5](#), they chose to follow an issuance model similar to bitcoin's, which meant that upon launch of its blockchain there would be zero units of zcash outstanding. From zero units outstanding, all units would be issued organically through miners competing to add blocks to Zcash's blockchain and getting paid with newly minted zcash via coinbase transactions. The Zcash team had implemented a further tweak, known as a *slow-start*, that would limit the initial size of coinbase transactions²² to miners. The slow-start was intended as a safety feature in case there were any bugs in Zcash's code. This prudent model was markedly different from the crowdsale model that many cryptoassets have been pursuing (which will be discussed further in [Chapter 16](#)), but it also drastically limited the initial supply.

Zcash frenzy was stoked further by the recent increase in popularity of futures trading of cryptoassets. One exchange known as BitMEX began offering futures prior to the launch of zcash, which spiked to 10 bitcoin per zcash.²³

The combination of limited initial supply with widespread demand led to a classic supply shortage that boosted the price of zcash. On the first day of trading, the coin momentarily